



December 11 2025

The Honorable Gavin Newsom  
Governor of California  
1021 O Street, Suite 9000  
Sacramento, CA 95814

**Link to bill text for Syd:** [https://ucmlsims.com/bills-pages/LAIRD\\_SB48.html](https://ucmlsims.com/bills-pages/LAIRD_SB48.html)

**Re: Senate Bill 48 - Support**

Dear Governor Newsom,

We, the California Teachers Association, are writing in support of Senate Bill 48, The Housing Innovation Program.

Introduced by the Honorable Senator John Laird, SB 48 is a vital piece of legislation written with the intent of addressing one of California's most prominent issues, the housing and affordability crisis. As one of many affordable housing bills introduced during this legislative session, SB 48 stands out for its clear and streamlined plan for creating more affordable housing, without interfering with currently occupied residences. Senator Laird's plan to provide organizations with grants to use for the purposes of revitalizing vacant buildings for use as affordable housing is one that would benefit all of California.

By specifically wording the bill to prioritize and set aside funds for rural/underserved areas as well as for places serving those pursuing higher education, Laird ensures that this bill supports those most affected by the dire state of the housing market. Setting aside a certain percentage of all grants for such communities will also help encourage organizations that may have otherwise overlooked them to invest in improving and supporting them, rather than simply focusing on areas that are already better off. Similarly, this bill is likely to help organizations expand their positive impact by scaling up their projects, as otherwise non-profit organizations may struggle to have the funds necessary to help on the scale that they desire to.

Finally, the requirement that the funds be used on renovating vacant buildings works to create more affordable housing without impacting or altering existing housing structures, as it takes advantage of a long-overlooked resource. Rehabilitating vacant buildings will also further help the communities they reside in, as vacant buildings often lower the values of the properties

surrounding them. By refurbishing them, this bill will also help to revive areas that may have historically been neglected or overlooked, all while still ensuring they provide housing at a cost accessible to the residents of California.

For these reasons, we strongly urge you to support SB 48.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Jack Klein". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Jack Anthony Klein (He/They) - Lobbyist  
**California Teachers Association**